Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't

Building a Design System with AI Agents

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Tbilisi JS Meetup #9 · 24 October 2026

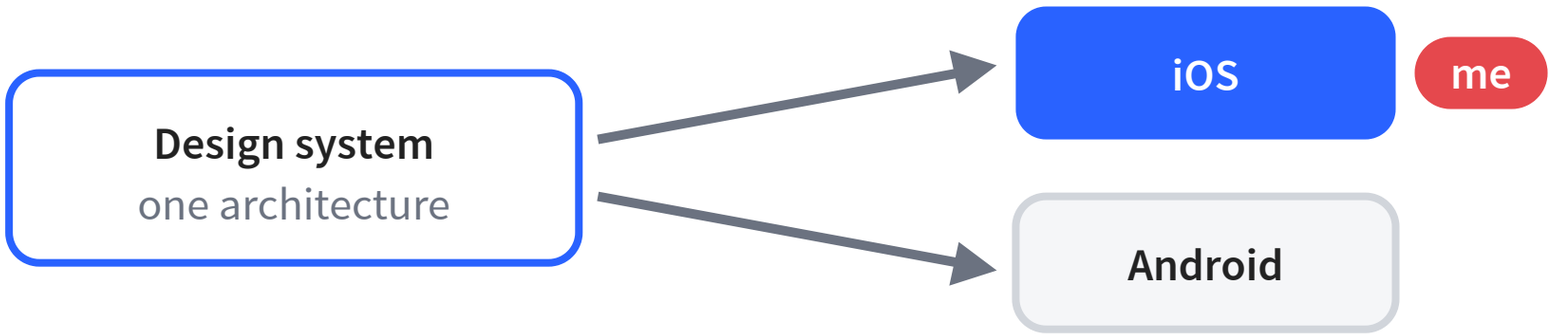
SETUP

The project

100M+
traders and investors

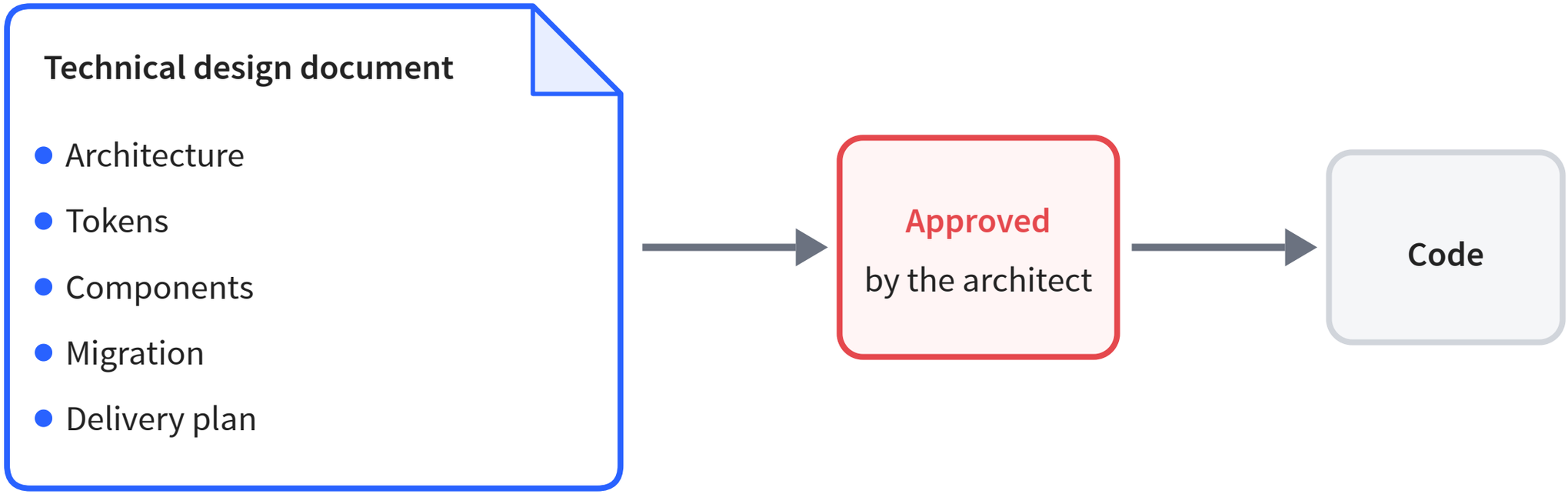
2011
founded

4.8★
421K App Store ratings



SETUP

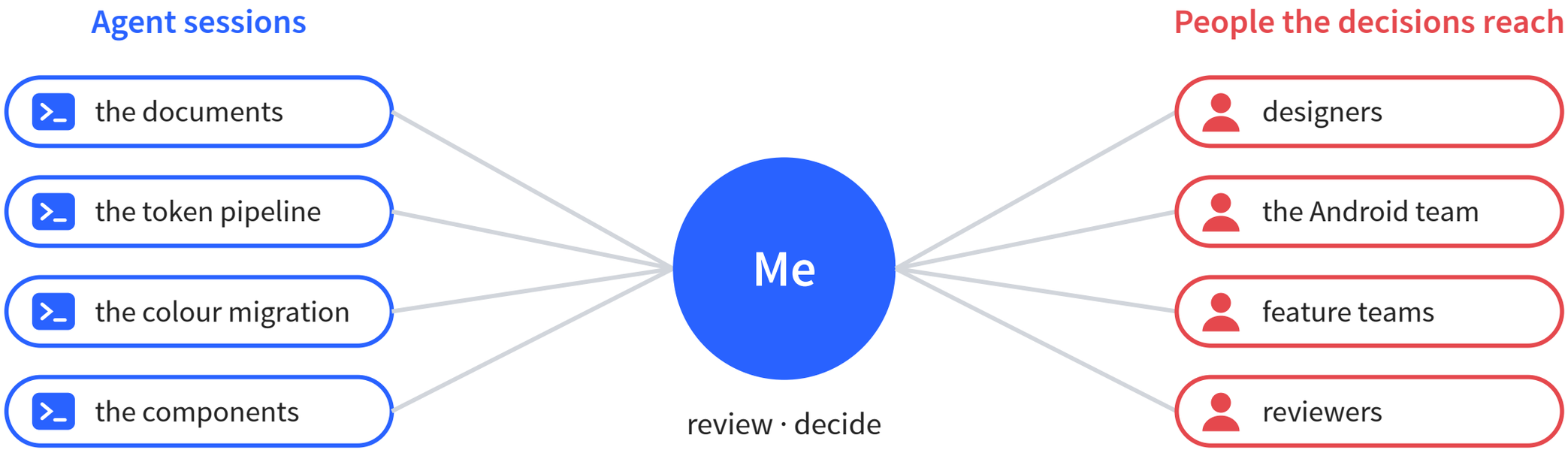
Design before code



So the work starts with deciding

SETUP

How the work runs



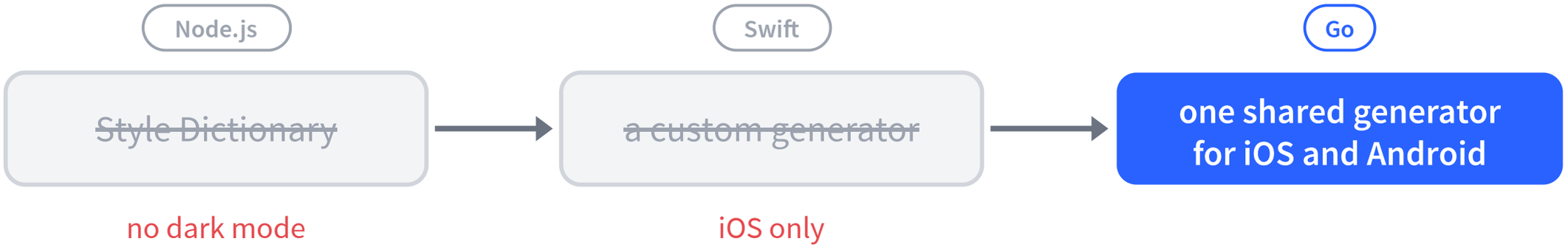
PART 1 OF 3

Code got cheap

The part agents sped up

CODE GOT CHEAP

Code is cheap: the token generator



Three generators in three days. The code was the easy part

CODE GOT CHEAP



A button. How hard can it be?

CODE GOT CHEAP

Argue, or build both and look

Before: argue

a custom button?

the platform's button?

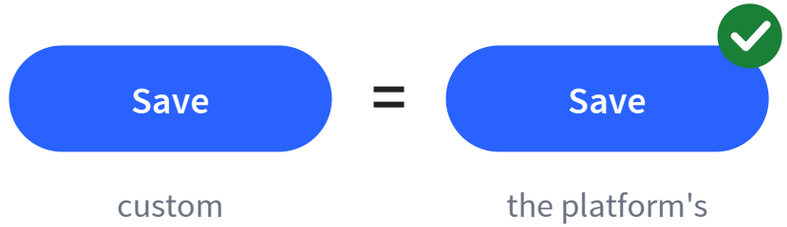
a raw control?

quirks…

Chosen on judgement: **a custom button**

The platform's button looked too limited: one icon slot, its own disabled look

After: build both, then look



Side by side: **"They look identical"**

The simpler one wins. The other is deleted the same day

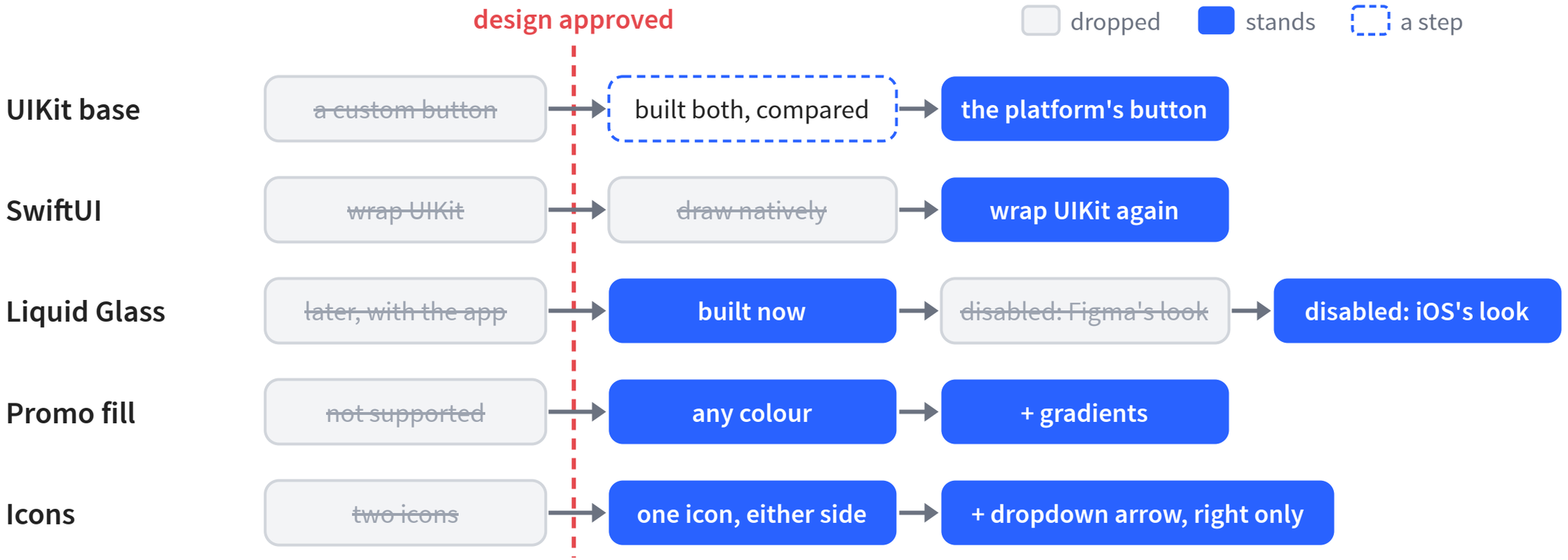
PART 2 OF 3

Decisions didn't

Where the time went

DECISIONS DIDN'T

One button, about 100 decisions

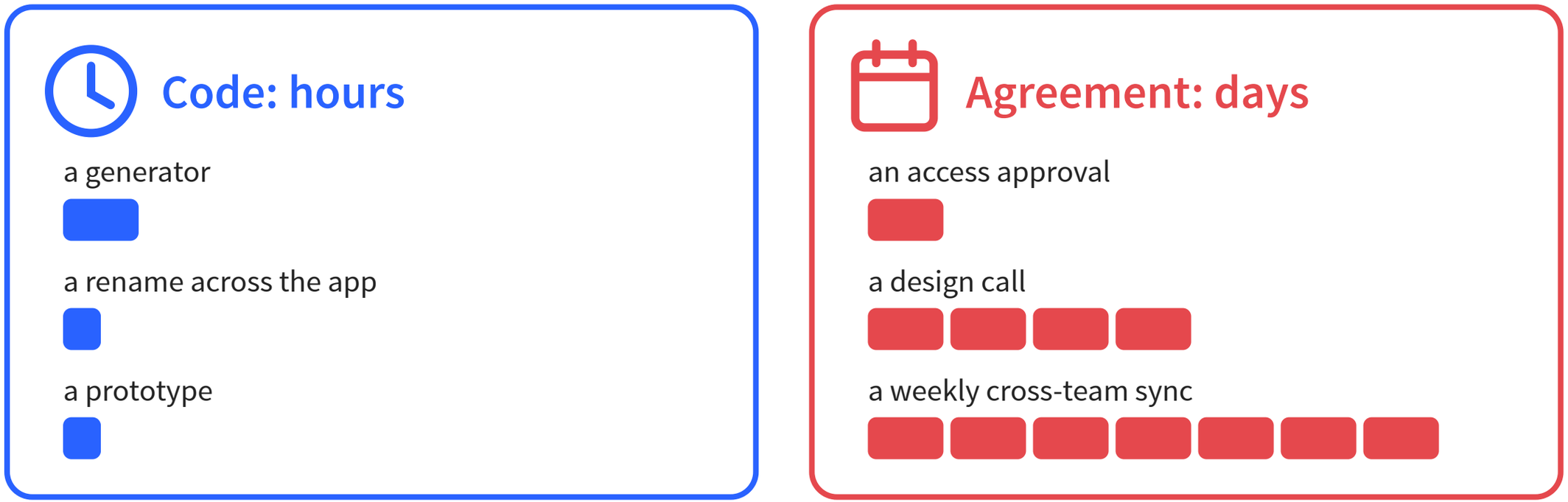


Half of them after the design was approved

Don't be afraid to be wrong: changing your mind got cheap

DECISIONS DIDN'T

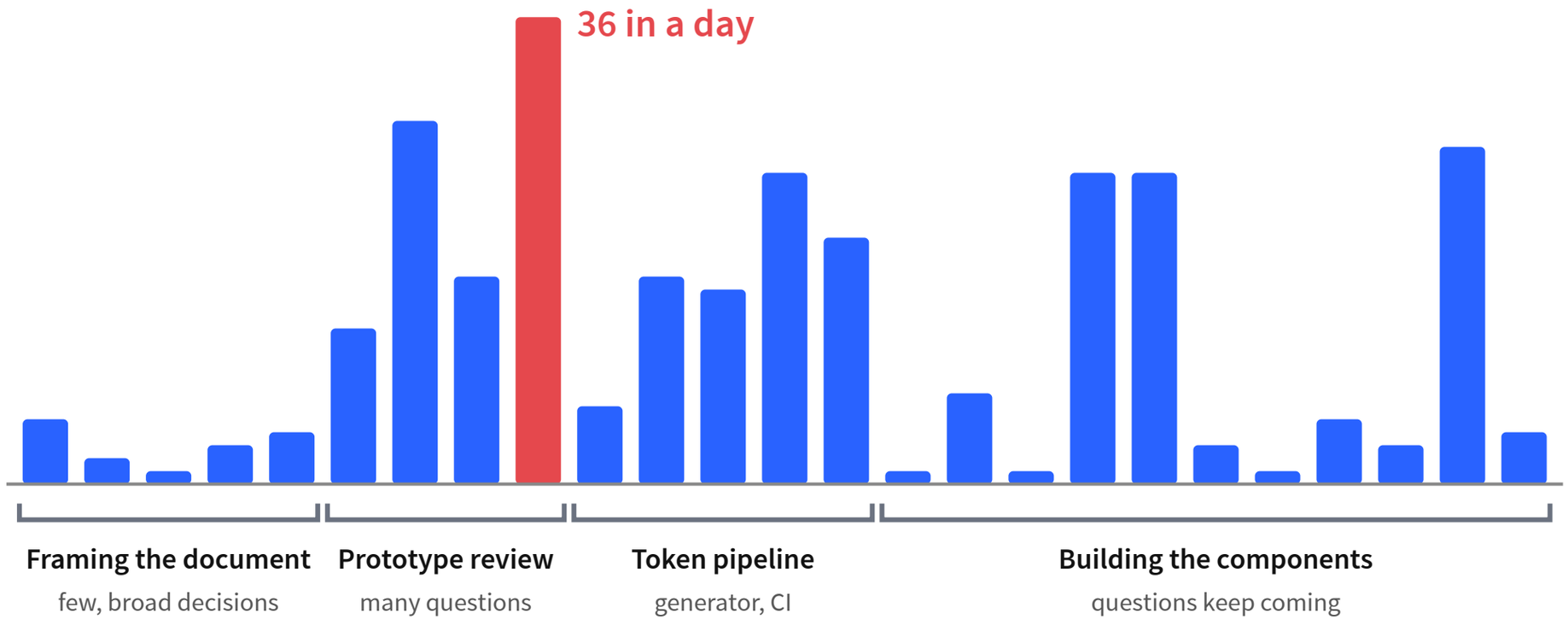
Agreeing takes calendar time



Nobody is slow: an agreement waits for a slot in someone's calendar

DECISIONS DIDN'T

313 decisions in a month



Each bar is a day with decisions

PART 3 OF 3

Keeping track of decisions

So you don't make them twice

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

Without a record

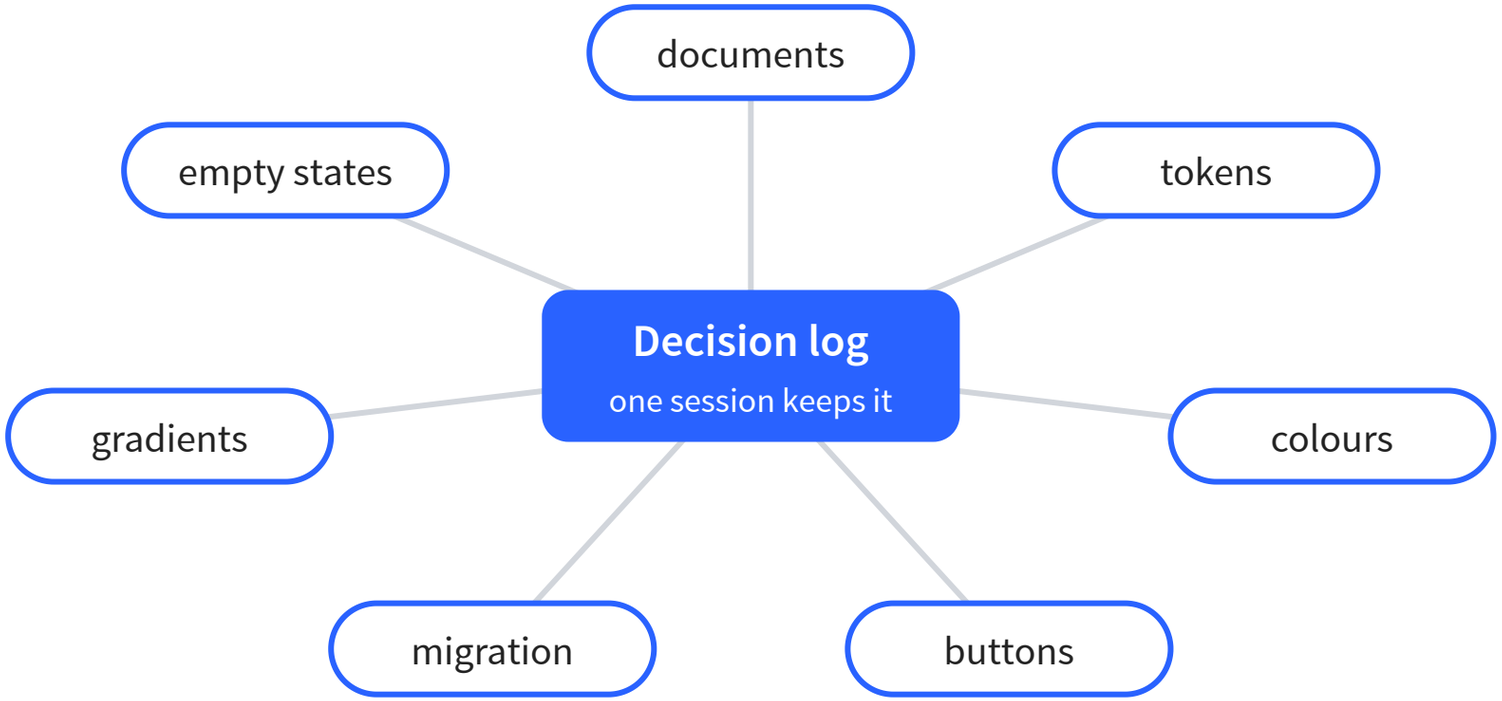
A rejected idea comes back
Proposed again after it was turned down

The state is spread out
Over a dozen files

Rebuilt by hand
After every agent restart

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

Many agents, one log

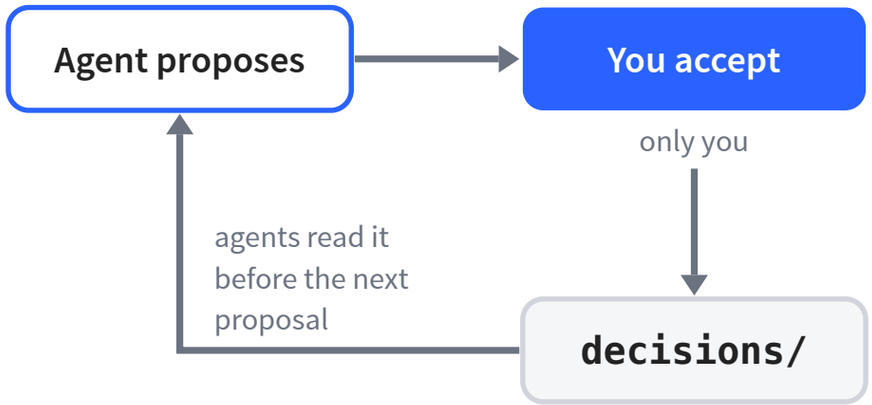


Every session reads the log before it proposes anything

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

decision-docs: what the plugin makes

```
docs/
├── current-state.md      where things stand now
├── decisions/            one ADR per decision
├── research/             background, may go stale
└── open-questions.md     undecided: don't guess, ask
```



a script keeps it consistent

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

What is an ADR?

Architecture Decision Record: a short note about one decision

Context	what problem, and why now
Options	what we considered
Decision	what we chose, and why
Consequences	the good and the bad

One decision, one file. Never rewritten: a new record replaces it

A real ADR, from this talk

`decisions/0002-title-the-talk-code-got-cheap-decisions-didnt.md`

Title the talk "Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't" accepted

Context The organisers needed a title. The audience doesn't know the project, so the title has to name the subject as well as the claim.

Considered options

- "Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't"
- "When Code Is Cheap, Decisions Are Expensive"
- "The Build Got Fast. Then What?"

Decision "Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't", because it states the claim, and its second half names the subject.

Consequences Bad, because "Decisions Didn't" is a promise: the talk has to show what decisions cost, with numbers.

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

And where things stand

`docs/current-state.md`

Current state

Present tense: the talk as it stands. Updated with each accepted decision.

- **Title:** "Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't" ADR-0002
- **Speaker:** the full name on the banners ADR-0004
- **Outline:** the announcement's three points ADR-0003
- **Internal material:** roles, not names or internal links ADR-0007
- **The plugin:** published, linked from the slides ADR-0006

Each line points at the decision behind it

KEEPING TRACK OF DECISIONS

This talk's own docs/

```
decisions/
├── 0001  Speak at Tbilisi JS Meetup #9
├── 0002  Title the talk "Code Got Cheap, Decisions Didn't"
├── 0003  Build the talk on the announcement's three points
├── 0004  Use the full name on the banners
├── 0005  Present decision-docs as the way to track decisions
├── 0006  Publish decision-docs before the talk
└── 0007  Show roles, not names or internal links
research/2026-10-12-talk-fact-sheet.md
```

decision-docs

a Claude Code plugin



github.com/**aleos/claude-plugins**

TAKEAWAYS

1

Plan for decisions and agreements, not code

TAKEAWAYS

2

Build the options instead of arguing about them

TAKEAWAYS

3

Write decisions down where agents read them

Thank you!

Questions?

Alexander Ostrovsky
Staff iOS Engineer, TradingView

decision-docs

a Claude Code plugin



github.com/**aleos/claude-plugins**